- *Who?* To properly execute accountability, make sure your organization always knows the following:
  - Who owns the given bit of data?
  - Who approves the given bit of data to use, and who decides its access rights?
  - Who sets up security measures to protect the given data, and what are they?
  - Who is responsible for compliance with data regulations?
  - Who is using the data?
- *What?* This indicates the precise definition of the kinds of data your organization processes, and *who* should have access to each type of data.
- *When?* If time constraints are placed on data availability (e.g., imposed by regulations), they should be taken into consideration by the data governance and clearly defined as to *what* kind of data access is time dependent for *whom*.
- *Where?* This question is critical from a data security point of view. Ensuring clear data storage for sensitive data makes it much easier to detect *who* accessed *what* and *when*.
- *Why?* Multiple constraints exist on data usage, whether legal or ethical. Ensuring that the data is used with a clear and proper purpose is one of the reasons behind setting up the whole data governance process.

Knowing all that will give your company a good understanding of the responsibilities of each person who has access to any bit of the company's data.

One thing to remember: as with most other data governance activities, answering these questions is not a one-off exercise. The data governance team needs to ensure that data assets are reviewed periodically (with the period depending on the nature of the data contained in each asset).

6.3.4 Implementation-level outcomes

The implementation level is where the hard work occurs, where data is generated, maintained, processed, and accessed. Without ensuring that all the policies are actually taken into account when implementation decisions are